

# PACHISI

VARIANT LIBRARY

*The ancient Indian race game behind Ludo, Sorry!, and Trouble*

|                      |                       |                  |
|----------------------|-----------------------|------------------|
| <b>3</b><br>VARIANTS | <b>2–4</b><br>PLAYERS | <b>8+</b><br>AGE |
|----------------------|-----------------------|------------------|

Published by Moddable Games · v0.1.0 · Printed 23 June 2026

# VARIANT LIBRARY

Pachisi is an ancient Indian cross-and-circle race game documented from approximately 500 CE, with precursor forms identified in the Painted Grey Ware period (c. 1100–800 BCE). The name derives from the Hindi word paccīs (twenty-five), the highest score achievable in the standard cowrie shell throw.

The game is the direct public domain ancestor of several major modern commercial titles:

- ♦ Ludo (1896, UK)
- ♦ Sorry! (1929, United States)
- ♦ Trouble (1965, United States)
- ♦ Aggravation (1962, United States)
- ♦ Parcheesi (US commercial edition)

This library documents only the original public domain Pachisi forms. Ludo, Sorry!, Trouble, and their commercial descendants are not included.

This library includes 3 variants.

## VARIANTS

- ♦ [Standard Pachisi](#) — 4 players, six cowrie shells, the foundational form
- ♦ [2-Player Pachisi](#) — 2-player adaptation with teams on the standard board
- ♦ [Seven-Shell Pachisi](#) — 7-cowrie variant with named throw values



Printed 23 June 2026

V0.1.0